

Hey Rohan, great speaking with you today. Your question about whether you're 'already too late' for AI engineering roles stuck with me -- you're not, and your 4 years of backend work on HDFC and Citi systems is actually a stronger foundation than most people walking into this space.

Your questions answered

1 Andrew Ng is great. So why pay Rs. 3.5L on top of that?

Honest answer: Coursera will teach you the concepts. What it won't do is make you ship 50+ projects with someone senior watching your code, prep you for product-company interviews with AI mock rounds, or put your profile in front of **900+ hiring partners** who have an existing relationship with Scaler. The gap between knowing RAG and getting hired to build RAG pipelines at a product company is accountability, structured depth, and a network -- not more video lectures. Your AWS cert proves you can self-study; the question is whether self-study alone will get you past the resume screen at a Razorpay or Atlassian.

2 Will this actually move you past 14 LPA, or just land you at another TCS?

You were clear: '14 to 16 at another service company and the math doesn't work' -- that's the right filter to apply. Scaler's verified data shows a **median salary hike of ~110% for the DS/ML track** as published on their website; that's the only figure we can put in writing here, and whether it maps precisely to your profile and target roles is something admissions can walk through with real benchmarks on your next call. What we can say is that the program is built for 0-7 YoE engineers targeting exactly the product-company switch you're describing, not a lateral service-to-service move. If the numbers don't hold up for your specific situation, you should know that before enrolling -- and that conversation is worth having on the second call.

3 RAG, agents, evals -- is it actually in the curriculum, or just on the brochure?

This is the right question to push on, and you'll see through fluff fast -- so here's what's verified: the curriculum explicitly includes **Prompt Engineering, RAG, and Multi-agent orchestration** under the AI and Agents module, plus an Agentic AI elective. That's not a theoretical ML course with a chatbot demo bolted on at the end. How deep the evals component goes and what the project briefs look like for those modules is exactly the kind of detail admissions can show you in the second call -- ask them to pull up a sample project spec for the RAG module specifically.

4 What the entrance test actually is

The entrance test is the gate to your second call and enrollment -- it's not a trick, it's how Scaler keeps the cohort at a level where 4-year engineers like you aren't sitting through basics. Given your B.Tech CSE background and 4 years of active development work, you're not starting from zero here. Exact prep resources and retake rules are confirmed by

admissions, so ask Meera for those details -- but clearing it is the one concrete next step between you and the full program breakdown.

TODAY Your current compensation depends on role and city. Happy to personalize on your next call.	TARGET PATH Stronger product and tech-facing roles depend on effort and market. We share realistic bands with admissions, not guesses.
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NOW Skills audit & entrance clarity	0-4 MO Core foundations & habits	4-8 MO Depth projects & design	8-12 MO Interview readiness
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Take the entrance test when you're ready -- it's the fastest way to get to the second call where the real numbers and curriculum details get laid out for your specific profile.